

Will McGowan

9 Clarendon Place, Glasgow G20 7PZ

+44 7562 299 515 | mcgowanwill366@gmail.com

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Graduate Recruitment Team
Man Group
Riverbank House, 2 Swan Lane
London EC4R 3AD

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Solutions Graduate Programme (2027 intake) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Man Group's Solutions programme, which rotates graduates through portfolio management, quant and advisory teams, would let me apply my asset-pricing research to the portfolios clients actually hold.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, forecasts European gas volatility with mixed-frequency (MIDAS) models built on storage, market and news-based data, evaluates them out-of-sample against HAR and AR benchmarks, and asks whether better forecasts improve a volatility-targeted TTF futures strategy. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. My lifetime poker winnings of over £40,000 came from respecting variance and sizing risk to a strict 50-buy-in bankroll rule, and as Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Man Group stands out to me because it runs systematic and discretionary investing on one platform, and clients have responded: assets under management reached a record \$253.6 billion at the end of June 2026, with \$7.1 billion of net inflows in the first half. The Solutions programme's mix of portfolio management, quant and advisory rotations fits how I like to work, from testing which factor premia survive across 54 countries to explaining the results to people who need to act on them.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan